



SITUATED IN THE HEART OF MICRONESIA in the Pacific Ocean lie

YAPESE

THE TRUE DESERT ISLANDS

the 134 islands—most of them unpopulated—that make up the State of Yap. The islands are scattered over 600 miles (950 km) of ocean, but the

THE BUILDINGS

There are three different types of buildings on the Yap Islands—the family house, the men's house, and this one, the *pebay*, which is the community house. It is a place where people get together for dances and meetings, and it also acts as a schoolhouse.



YAP DAY

On the first of March each year the islanders celebrate Yap Day—a festival commemorating the rich culture and lifestyle of the islands. All the villages perform dances that tell stories, and contests are held to find the best sportsman and the provider of the finest local produce. The dances are prepared and practiced all year and are always performed in large groups.

Yap Island

The main town on Yap is Conolia, which is situated around a bay. Although it is the center of tourism and government, most Yapese people live in villages located outside the town, where they lead an uninfluenced lifestyle. The main occupations of the people on the island are farming and fishing.

NAVIGATING THE SEAS

Living on the small, scattered islands of Yap has meant that over thousands of years the people have become some of the greatest of the Pacific navigators. They use large, wooden outrigger canoes, which can go at incredible speeds and hold many people for long journeys, and smaller outrigger boats, such as this one, for local fishing.

